

TRUSTMRR MARKETPLACE DATASET ~ Based on 1000 row data

What 1,000 Internet Businesses Teach Us About Building Successful Digital Companies

Insights from the TrustMRR Marketplace Dataset

Instead of analyzing unicorns, this presentation studies 1,000 real internet businesses to uncover the patterns behind sustainable digital growth.

1,000

COMPANIES

65

COUNTRIES

29

CATEGORIES

\$15.6M

30-DAY REVENUE

WHAT DOES THE DATASET REPRESENT?

1,000 operating internet businesses across 65 countries — the real startup economy, not a venture-funded highlight reel.



1,000

COMPANIES



65

COUNTRIES



29

CATEGORIES



\$15.6M

COMBINED 30-DAY REVENUE



32.7M

MONTHLY VISITORS



500,597

ACTIVE SUBSCRIBERS



\$35K

MEDIAN ASKING PRICE



26%

LISTED FOR SALE



This dataset captures operating internet businesses rather than venture-funded success stories — making it a unique lens into the real startup economy.

IS STARTUP SUCCESS EVENLY DISTRIBUTED?

No. Revenue follows a power law — the top 10% of businesses capture 84% of all revenue.

\$15,596

MEAN MONTHLY REVENUE

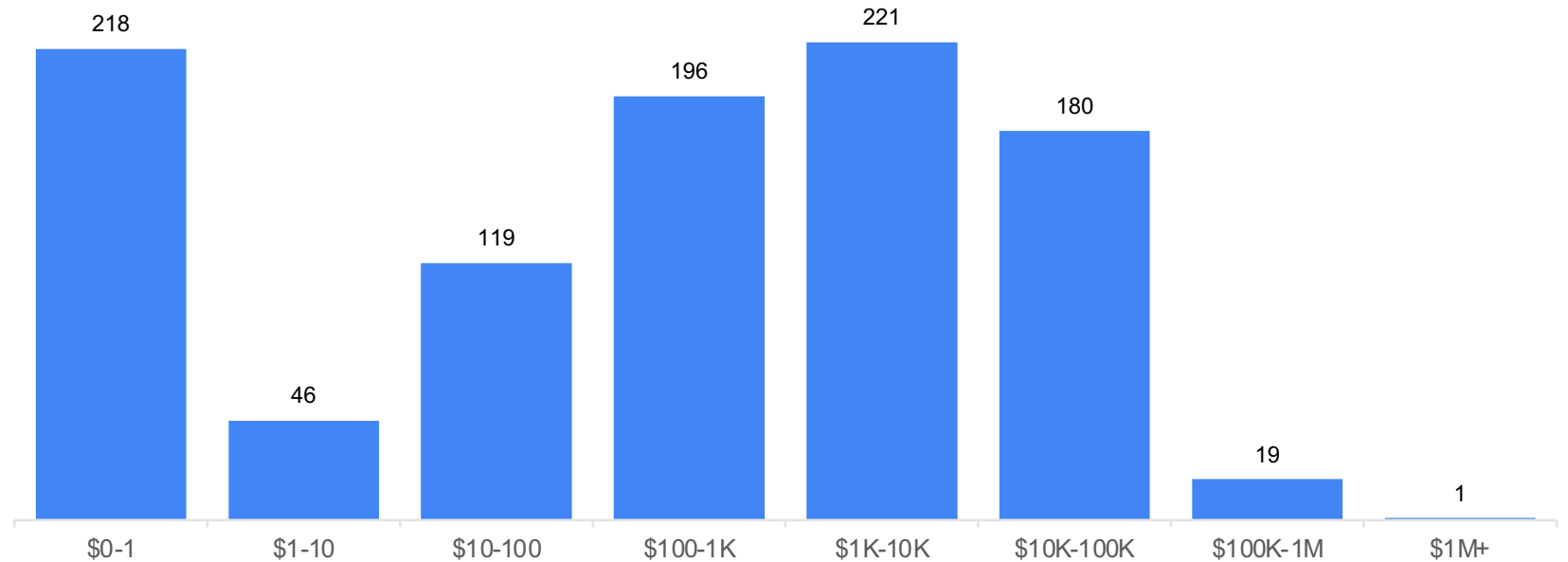
\$400

MEDIAN MONTHLY REVENUE

\$2.84M

MAXIMUM REVENUE

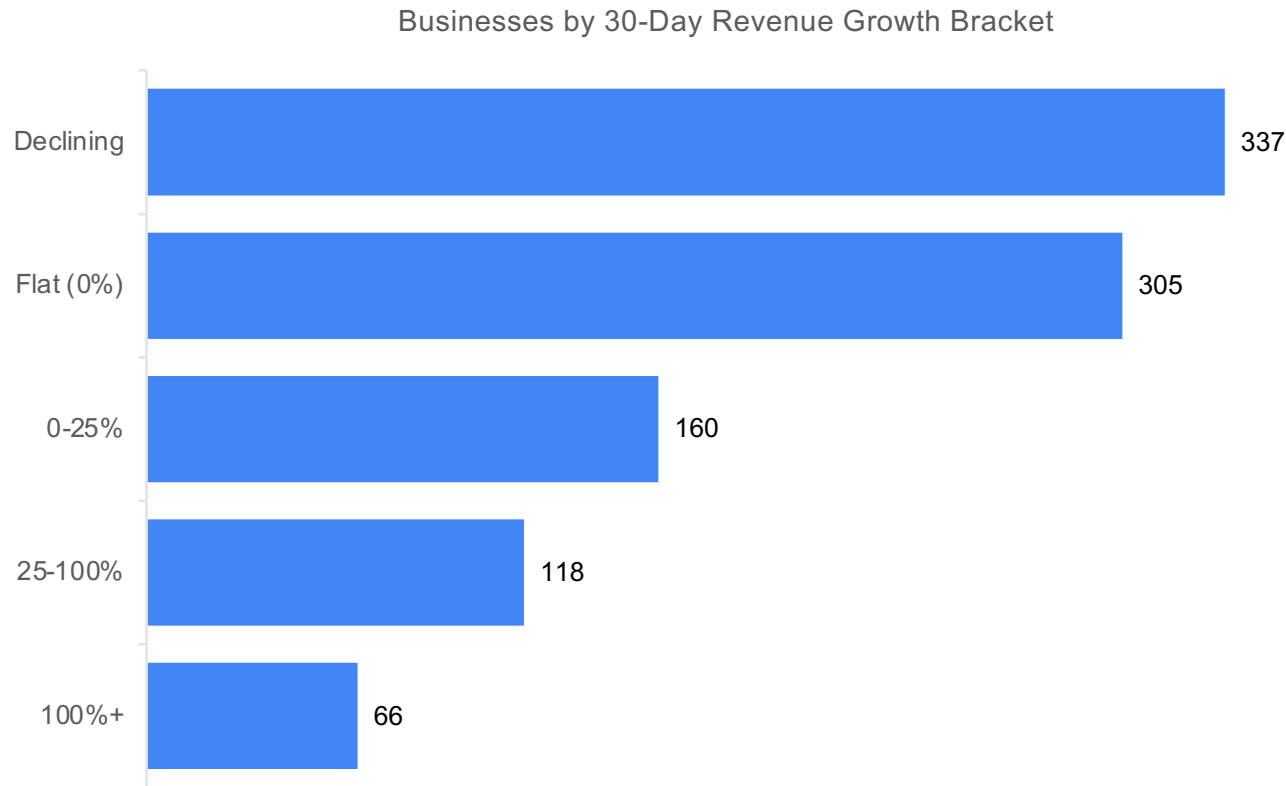
Number of Companies by 30-Day Revenue Bracket (Log Scale)



"The average startup does not exist."

DO STARTUPS GROW UNIFORMLY?

No. Growth is concentrated — 1 in 3 businesses shrank last month while a handful grew over 100x.



0%

MEDIAN GROWTH

+41.9%

AVERAGE GROWTH

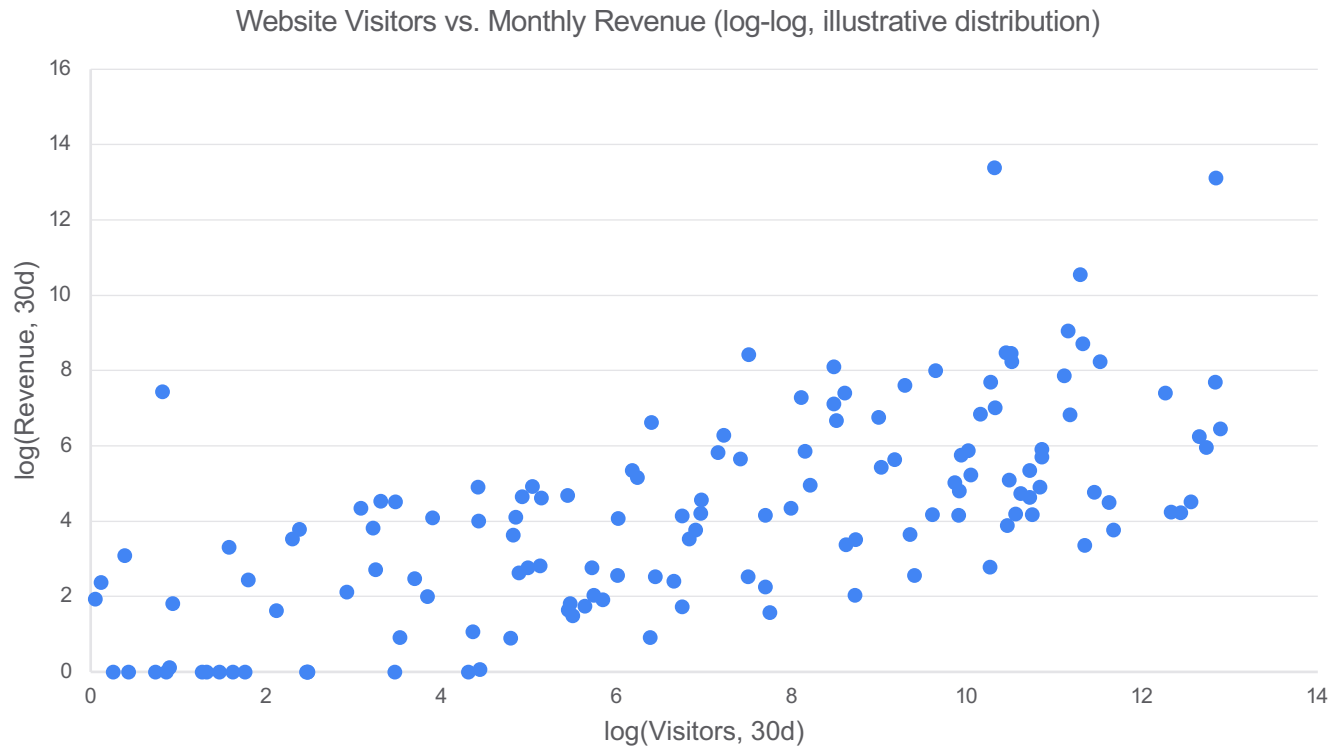
+7,900%

HIGHEST GROWTH

⚡ Growth is highly skewed: the median business was flat or shrinking, while a small set of breakout companies account for most observed growth.

DOES POPULARITY TRANSLATE INTO PERFORMANCE?

Barely. Visitor volume explains only a fraction of revenue — monetization efficiency is what separates winners.



"Attention is abundant. Monetization is scarce."

0.16

TRAFFIC → REVENUE CORRELATION

\$0.40

MEDIAN REVENUE / VISITOR

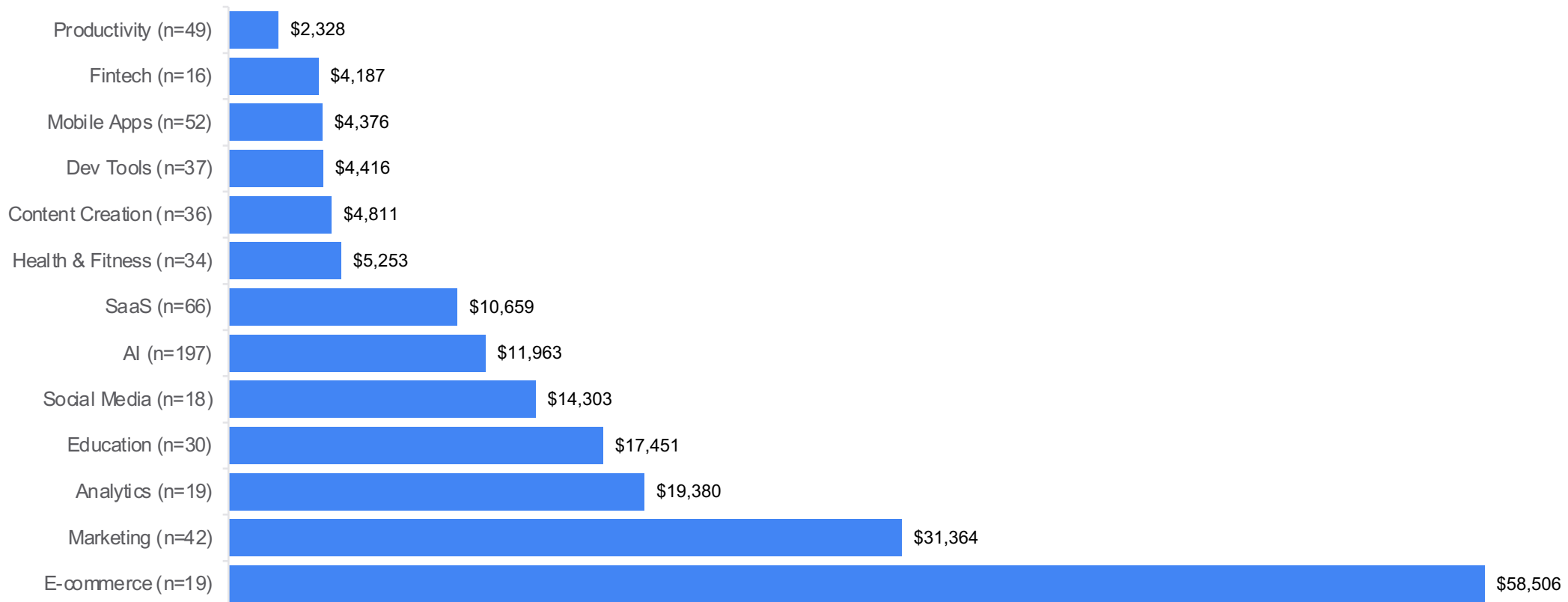
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TOP-50 TRAFFIC $\cap$ TOP-50 REVENUE

WHICH INDUSTRIES DOMINATE — AND DO THEY ACTUALLY PERFORM BETTER?

The largest category isn't the best-performing one. E-commerce and Marketing businesses out-earn AI on average.

Average 30-Day Revenue by Category (min. 15 companies)



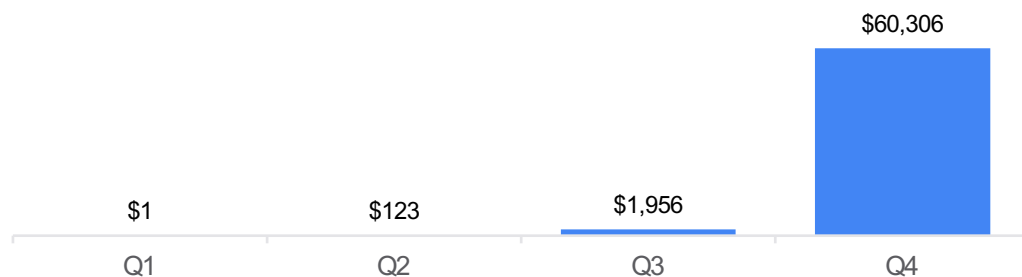
AI is the largest category by company count (197) but ranks 6th by average revenue — category size and category productivity are different questions.

WHAT SEPARATES THE BEST COMPANIES FROM THE REST?

Top-quartile businesses monetize traffic ~19x more efficiently and hold 23x more subscribers than the bottom quartile.

Metric	Q1 (Bottom 25%)	Q2	Q3	Q4 (Top 25%)
Avg. Monthly Revenue	\$0.57	\$123	\$1,956	\$60,306
Avg. 30-Day Growth	-12.8%	+78.0%	+84.5%	+17.5%
Avg. Subscribers	78	12	143	1,769
Avg. Revenue / Visitor	\$0.03	\$2.77	\$2.54	\$48.83
Avg. Revenue Multiple	16.1x	10.7x	4.3x	3.3x

Avg. Monthly Revenue by Quartile (linear scale)



Notably, revenue multiples fall as revenue rises (16.1x → 3.3x) — buyers pay a premium for unproven upside, not proven cash flow.

Five data-backed insights



1. Revenue follows a power law.

The top 10% of businesses capture 84% of all revenue in the dataset.



2. Growth is concentrated among very few companies.

1 in 3 businesses shrank last month; a handful drove nearly all reported growth.



3. Category leadership does not guarantee performance.

AI leads in company count (197) but ranks 6th of 13 categories by average revenue.



4. Monetization efficiency matters more than traffic.

Traffic explains only a fraction of revenue variance; revenue-per-visitor is the real driver.



5. Top performers win broadly, not narrowly.

Top-quartile businesses out-perform on revenue, subscribers, and monetization at once.

"The value of this dataset lies not in describing 1,000 companies, but in revealing the hidden patterns that distinguish exceptional businesses from average ones."